



Bot-Valley - R&D

of the automation requirements from companies located in Europe and the USA. I used to wonder why India does not have a manufacturer of robots and other automation equipment suppliers for factories and warehouses.

That curiosity of not having a robotics factory in India got over in 2016 when we decided to start Addverb. We had gained tremendous insight by working on the latest technologies and had also operated these factories and warehouses. We felt we could create some unique offerings by merging the knowledge of technology and operations and that's how the push went ahead.

It was in June 2016 that we started Addverb Technologies in a two-room setup located in Tagore Gardens, New Delhi. All of the five co-founders of Addverb are from the Asian Paints team. We moved to Noida Sector 2 in 2018 and now we have inaugurated a brand new facility in Noida itself. From the first year to the closure of the previous financial year, we have covered a journey from 1.5 crore (15 million) rupees in turnover to around 200 crores (2,000 million) rupees in five years.

### Why the name Addverb? What does it imply?

'Add' stands for addition and 'verb' stands for action, which means we are

adding to actions in factories and warehouses. The action that we add value to is 'motion' or 'movement'—movement to everything, and we intend to make that movement/motion safe, productive, effective, and less stressful. We give primacy to motion—our operating universe. It is in motion or movement that we think and thrive. It is what we do with motion that defines who we are.

### How have the last three years been for Addverb? What is the roadmap for the future?

We were able to create unique offerings by merging the experiences we had gained in managing operations of automated facilities with technology. We created some very unique solutions for customers that helped us win their trust at the early stages. Addverb is one of the rare companies in the world which makes conventional and flexible automation solutions. This has opened a host of industries for us; as you can see, our clientele spans across multiple industries like petrochemicals, retail, e-commerce, FMCG, tyres, and pharma, to name a few.

Our first orders were from the likes of Patanjali, Megha Fruits, Reliance Retail, and PAR Pharma, where we automated their factories and warehouses. Then came the orders of auto-

mation from the likes of HUL, Flipkart, Coca-Cola, Pepsico, and Amazon. The word of mouth really worked well for us. The word kept spreading and we kept on getting orders from many big and small organisations. Also, Addverb team's ability to deliver orders in time played a key role in making it a successful venture as we kept on getting repeat orders from our customers.

In the journey, we decided that we are going to invest heavily on an R&D team as it is the core requirement of making any robotics company successful. Robotics, especially mobile robotics, is still an evolving field and many answers still need to be discovered or developed. Investing in R&D is the only way to do it. All the cofounders of Addverb are aware that China leads in terms of robots and even Japan based brands have become distributors of robots and cobots manufactured in China. We, at Addverb, do not want to repeat the mistakes that these Japanese companies have made. The only answer to not do so lies in extensive R&D to solve existing problems in a more innovative way and developing robust and intelligent software.

### Speaking of robot companies originating from China, how do you plan to compete against them?

The government of China was among the earliest ones to invest heavily in technologies including AI, ML, and robotics. They had a simple vision that if no human is available to do some kind of work, AI, ML, and robotics will be helpful to do that work. China knew back then that robotics will help the nation keep its tag of world's manufacturing superpower. As I said earlier, if there is any country that can compete against China, it is India. The plan is to compete against China, where some of the best robotics companies in the world are. Companies like GeekPlus, Hikvision, and QuickTron have emerged successfully in the robotics landscape.

When the pandemic hit, we were sure that these Chinese companies would come to set up shop here in India. We were preparing ourselves for the same accordingly. In fact, that is one of the reasons we started our office in Singapore. Instead of waiting for them to come to India, we made plans to compete with them outside India. We are already competing with them in South East Asia and we will definitely compete with them once we open an office in the United States.